Dhāraṇī for Retaining the Perfection of Wisdom in One Hundred Thousand Lines

Toh 939 · Derge Kangyur

This brief work, known in English as the Dhāraṇī by Which One Comes to Retain the Perfection of Wisdom in One Hundred Thousand Lines, is a short incantation devoted to the great Perfection of Wisdom scripture. It opens with homage to the Blessed Mother, the Noble Perfection of Wisdom, and then gives a Sanskrit mantra that invokes the Dharma under various aspects, including gathering, kindness, and liberation, along with a reference to Vaiśravaṇa. A second, shorter formula calls upon wisdom, hearing, memory, and victory. The text promises that whoever retains this dhāraṇī will come to retain the vast Perfection of Wisdom in One Hundred Thousand Lines itself, which reflects the close link between memorized spells and the preservation of scripture. It is Toh 939 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the dhāraṇī texts, the collection of protective and empowering incantations that appears alongside the tantra section of the canon.

Homage to the Blessed Mother, the Noble Perfection of Wisdom.

tadyathā oṃ muni dharme saṃgraha dharme anugraha dharme vimukti dharme sadā ānugraha dharme vaiśravaṇa parivartita dharme sarva kārya vare pramaṇa dharme samatā parivartan dharme svāhā

oṃ prajñe śruti smṛti vijaye dhīḥ dharṇīye svāhā

By retaining this, one will come to retain the Perfection of Wisdom in One Hundred Thousand Lines.

This completes the dhāraṇī by which one comes to retain the Perfection of Wisdom in One Hundred Thousand Lines.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.